

Software Testing / QA Interview Questions & Answers

Candidate: Jayaprakash R

Prepared from the skills and project details in the provided resume. The answers are written for a fresher/junior QA interview.

1. Tell me about yourself.

Answer: My name is Jayaprakash. I completed my Bachelor of Computer Applications from MGR Arts and Science College, Hosur. I have knowledge of Manual Testing and Automation Testing. I worked on an E-commerce website project where I worked with test cases, Selenium WebDriver, Java, TestNG, Cucumber BDD and JIRA. I also have basic knowledge of SQL and API testing. I am interested in starting my career as a Software Tester and improving my testing and automation skills.

2. Explain your E-commerce project.

Answer: My project was an E-commerce website. The main modules were user registration, product search, add to cart, payment and order confirmation. I analysed the business requirements and functional specifications, prepared and executed test cases, and automated test scenarios using Selenium WebDriver, Cucumber BDD and TestNG. I also reported defects in JIRA and collaborated with developers to resolve them. The project followed Agile methodology.

3. What was your role in the project?

Answer: My role was mainly related to software testing. I analysed requirements, prepared test cases, executed functional tests, automated selected test scenarios using Selenium, identified defects and reported them in JIRA. I also participated in Agile activities such as sprint planning, daily stand-ups and sprint retrospectives.

4. What is Software Testing?

Answer: Software testing is the process of verifying and validating a software application to identify defects and ensure that the application meets the specified requirements.

5. What is Manual Testing?

Answer: Manual testing is testing an application manually without using automation tools. The tester executes test cases, compares actual results with expected results and reports defects.

6. What is Automation Testing?

Answer: Automation testing uses tools and scripts to execute test cases automatically. In my project, I used Selenium WebDriver with Java for web application automation.

7. What is a test case?

Answer: A test case is a set of steps, test data, preconditions and expected results used to verify a particular functionality. Example: for login, enter valid username and password, click Login and verify that the user reaches the home page.

8. What is a test scenario?

Answer: A test scenario is a high-level functionality or condition that needs to be tested. Example: Verify the login functionality.

9. What is the difference between Severity and Priority?

Answer: Severity represents how seriously a defect affects the application, while priority represents how quickly the defect should be fixed.

10. Explain the Defect Life Cycle.

Answer: A defect generally moves through states such as New, Assigned, Open, Fixed, Retest, Verified and Closed. If the issue still exists during retesting, it can be Reopened.

11. How do you report a bug in JIRA?

Answer: First, I reproduce the issue and collect the required information. Then I create a defect in JIRA with a clear summary, description, steps to reproduce, expected result, actual result, severity, priority and supporting screenshots or evidence. Then I assign or link it to the appropriate developer or team.

12. What is Selenium WebDriver?

Answer: Selenium WebDriver is an automation tool used to automate web applications. It allows us to interact with web elements such as buttons, text boxes, links and dropdowns through programming languages like Java.

13. What are locators in Selenium?

Answer: Locators are used to identify web elements on a webpage. Common Selenium locators include ID, Name, Class Name, Tag Name, Link Text, Partial Link Text, CSS Selector and XPath.

14. What is XPath?

Answer: XPath is a path expression used to locate elements in an HTML or XML document. It is useful when elements do not have a unique ID or when we need to locate elements based on their attributes or relationships. Example: `//input[@id='username']`.

15. What is the difference between implicit wait and explicit wait?

Answer: Implicit wait tells Selenium to wait for a specified amount of time when searching for elements. Explicit wait waits for a specific condition to occur, such as an element becoming visible or clickable.

16. What is TestNG?

Answer: TestNG is a testing framework used with Java. It helps us organise and execute test cases and provides features such as annotations, test grouping, prioritisation and reporting.

17. What is Cucumber BDD?

Answer: Cucumber is a BDD framework that allows test scenarios to be written in a readable format using Gherkin language. It commonly uses keywords such as Given, When, Then, And and But.

18. What is Maven?

Answer: Maven is a build and dependency management tool used in Java projects. It helps manage project dependencies, build the project and execute tests.

19. What is Regression Testing?

Answer: Regression testing is performed to ensure that changes or new fixes have not negatively affected existing functionality.

20. What is Smoke Testing?

Answer: Smoke testing is a basic level of testing performed to check whether the major functionalities of a build are working and whether the build is stable enough for detailed testing.

21. What is Sanity Testing?

Answer: Sanity testing is focused testing performed after a minor change or bug fix to verify that the specific functionality and related areas are working correctly.

22. How would you test an E-commerce Login page?

Answer: I would test both positive and negative scenarios: valid username and password, invalid username, invalid password, empty fields, password masking, forgot password functionality and account lock behaviour if applicable.

23. How would you test Add to Cart?

Answer: I would verify that the user can select a product and add it to the cart. I would check product name, quantity, price, total amount, removing the product, updating quantity and cart persistence. I would also check behaviour for unavailable or out-of-stock products.

24. How would you test an online payment?

Answer: I would test successful payment, failed payment, cancelled payment, invalid payment details, timeout, duplicate payment attempts and network interruption. I would also verify that the order status and payment status are updated correctly.

25. What if payment succeeds but the order is not created?

Answer: First, I would reproduce the issue and collect the transaction details. I would verify the payment status and order status, check the API or application response if available, and report the defect with clear steps, test data, expected result and actual result. I would also provide the transaction or reference information to help the development team investigate.

26. What is SQL?

Answer: SQL stands for Structured Query Language. It is used to communicate with and retrieve or manipulate data in relational databases. Example: `SELECT * FROM employees;`

27. What is API Testing?

Answer: API testing is testing an application's APIs directly to verify whether they return the correct response for different requests and inputs. I have basic knowledge of API testing.

28. Explain Agile methodology.

Answer: Agile is a software development methodology where work is divided into smaller iterations called sprints. Teams continuously develop, test and deliver features while taking feedback and adapting to changes.

29. What happens in a Daily Stand-up?

Answer: In a daily stand-up, team members usually discuss what they completed yesterday, what they plan to work on today and whether they have any blockers.

30. Why should we hire you as a Software Tester?

Answer: I have a good foundation in software testing and knowledge of both manual and automation testing. I have worked with Selenium, Java, TestNG, Cucumber BDD, JIRA and Maven, and I also have basic SQL and API testing knowledge. I am a quick learner, detail-oriented and interested in continuously improving my testing skills. I am ready to learn the company's processes and contribute to the QA team.

Top 10 Questions to Practise First

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Explain your E-commerce project.
3. What was your role in the project?
4. Explain your Selenium framework.
5. How do you write test cases?
6. Explain Severity vs Priority.
7. Explain the Defect Life Cycle and JIRA.
8. Explain Selenium waits and XPath.
9. Explain TestNG and Cucumber BDD.
10. How would you test an E-commerce website?